CREW WORK = BOAT BALANCE

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A good crew is one that knows how to communicate with the boat through body weight, sail trim and anticipation. A crew's body position and movement in a boat has a major effect on the boats speed and handling. A good college crew can anticipate tactical situations and will know his or her job in each of them. A good college crew makes any skipper great.

SLITHER TECHIQUE

This is how you move in the boat. Keeping your shoulders square to the bow and moving in and out on the rail of the boat while on your side. This will make it easier to move in and out of the boat smoothly.

- Use your shoulders to shift your weight
- Keep your shoulders square to the bow
- Keep on the balls of your feet
- Slide in and out of the boat on your side or hip rather then your butt.
- Roll the boat with your hip on the rail and powering your shoulders through your roll.
- Use your feet on the hull or Centerboard trunk to shift your weight
- Solid, confident footwork helps you cross the boat well.
- Pressing- in light to medium air when crews are in the middle use your elbow and hand to press the rail to flatten.

WEIGHT ON BOAT

- Heel to windward, boat heads down
- Heel to Leeward, boat heads up
- Move weight forward in lighter air
- Move weight back as breeze builds
- Your weight matters a lot, keep weight close to skipper

JIB TRIM

- Always changing—look at telltales and Luff.
- Look at top of jib, the top telltales and relationship of main and jib are critical.
- Downwind top of jib much more important than bottom
- Don't over trim out of tacks—keep eased and then trim
- Keep jib eased around leeward mark—slowly trim, ok if it luffs a little
- Jib eased and main in—heads boat up
- Jib trimmed and main out—head boat down

CENTERBOARD

- Up all the way when dead downwind
- ½ way up on reaches (some exceptions)
- All the way down upwind (unless really breezy)

BAILER

- Laundry bottle or Tropicana White bottle best

--Cut bottom, keep top on tight
--Put a lanyard on it with a barrel knot on the end

- Always have 2
- Keep stored in boat with lanyard tucked into halyard
- Boat must be dry
- Practice bailing and sailing

HIKING STRAPS

- They are adjustable
- Loosen to get butt outside of black rail
- Check for possible breakdowns
- In 420's push the skippers straps all the way forward towards the crew and use the last loop.

HIKING FORM

- Hips in line with chest
- Out and Down—when puff is on as well as out of tacks
- Don't have body go below the rail of the boat
- Keep shoulders pointed out
- Roll and Reach—to be able to look all around
- Head always looking in right direction
- Don't forget to breathe
- When hiking hard in breeze keep your feet together, shoulder even with your hips.

MARK ROUNDINGS

- Weather mark—hike hard to windward and keep jib trimmed in to bear away
- Leeward Mark—heel to leeward to help turn up and slowly trim jib so it follows the bow. Even ok to let the first inch of the jib to luff around the mark.
- When shooting a mark—ease jib to help the boat head up
- When holding position on start line—heel to leeward to stay up and to windward to head down
- Tight hole on starting line—lean to leeward

STARTING ACCELERATION

- Keep weight in the middle of boat to keep the boat flat.
- To start acceleration, jib trim enough for clew of the jib to fill
- Next the main needs to go in tight
- Then slowly trim the jib so it follows the bow.

SYNERGY

Your relationship with you skipper is like the one of a golf caddy and his super star golfer. You provide the weapons the insight on your environment and most importantly you give your skipper the confidence to execute on the highest level. When an athlete sees a teammate performing perfectly around him it only raises his game. Sailing is a mentally challenging game so to succeed you must excel on two plans at once. The first, physically you must be sharp in the boat with your own technique but also keep your

timing and technique in sync with your skipper. So rolling the boat and flattening at the same time is a big part, but also balancing the boat to compensate or enhance your skippers movements. The best way to succeed physically is to use your brain and work on predicting your skippers movements. In practice you should not just go through the motions but work with your skipper to learn what he or she is thinking and understand the right move for the given situation. If you know the move ahead of time your prepared to execute it flawlessly. Like a good football team that has a script for every play and every situation, you too must have this with your skipper. Most of your plays will come from muscle memory, in which case lots of practice makes perfect. But there are still a lot of moves you must know because you do the homework whether it comes to fleet racing or team racing. You must get to a point where you feel comfortable calling the shots. The only way to get better at this is to do it and make mistakes, learn and move on. The second plan is the mental game, like the physical this takes practice and homework. Your behavior and reactions to good and bad situations are always being looked at by your skipper. If you respond to a bad situation by putting your head in the sand or being angry it will through your skippers mental state into a world whirlwind. You must be that good caddy, injecting confidence when needed and keeping the skipper focused on the basic fundamentals you can control. Remind your skipper that you guys are ready to play and we are just one move from getting back into the top. Find the breeze, work on making the boat go and be focused on your task at hand. Offer information, not commands, offer confidence not defeat, and most importantly offer simplicity, never complexity. Your post race recap needs to be filled with facts rather then emotion. Focus on improvement and the score will take care of itself.